World Religions

World-religions teaching collection prepared using existing course resources; original source acknowledgments retained.

Full teaching files

catholicism week 2 student NEW	*3 pages*
catholicism week 2 teacher NEW	*4 pages*
World Religions CATHOLIC student	*2 pages*
World Religions CATHOLIC TEACHER	*3 pages*
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Copy of FINAL JEOPARDY ANSWER	*1 pages*
Copy of FINAL JEOPARDY QUESTION	*1 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.



WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

CATHOLICISM WEEK 2

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Catholic Bible**

   ✓ Contains additional books (the Apocrypha)- Romans 3:2

   ✓ This Bible is traced back to Alexandria, Egypt to the Codex's Sinaiticus and Vaticanus and also from the Latin Vulgate primarily translated by Jerome. ALL modern translations in existence today trace back to this corrupt line of manuscripts EXCEPT for the KJV

   ✓ Many verses have been altered or removed similar to translations like the NIV, NASB, etc. (Ex – Acts 8:37-38) Most do not believe in the final authority or preservation of God's Word.

   WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

   God promised to keep and preserve His words - Psalm 12:6-7; Psalm 119:89; Matthew 24:35

   God's words are magnified above His name - Psalm 138:2; 1 Tim. 6:1; Titus 1:2; Jn. 1:1; Rev. 19:13

   His word IS TRUTH, it is where we get the truth. It is our authority!- John 17:17

2. **Traditions**

   ✓ Traditions that were handed down by papal and/or council decree:

   - Infallibility of the Pope, Worship of Mary (Immaculate Conception, Ascension of Mary), Purgatory, using Latin language, kissing the Pope's feet, celibacy of the priesthood, Lent, Canonization of dead saints, Holy water, Indulgences, Transubstantiation, Confession of sins to a priest, refusing the bible to be studied by laymen, clothing, jewelry, chants, decorations/icons, rosary, statues, pilgrimages, etc.

   ✓ The "spiritual experiences" of Catholics around the world (Statue of Mary crying; healing by touching the Pope; image of Mary in grilled cheese sandwich; etc. – These things end up becoming sacred)

   WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

   Mankind habitually makes the commandments of God of none effect through tradition - Matthew 15:1-3, 6; Colossians 2:8; Titus 1:10-16; Isaiah 29:13; 2 Timothy 3

3. **Magisterium of the Church** (Modeled after Pagan Rome)**:**

RCC		ROME
Pope	⁉	Emperor
Cardinals	⁉	Senate
Archbishops	⁉	Imperial Governors
Bishops	⁉	Provincial Governors
Priests	⁉	Civitas (Mayor)

   The RCC will say that their leaders word is greater than or equal to the authority of scripture or tradition. Even calling them infallible!

WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

Each local church is independent and self-governing – Acts 14:23

There are only 2 offices in the local church:

1) Bishop (Elder, Pastor) – 1 Tim. 3:1-2; Titus 1:5-7; Acts 20:17, 28
2) Deacons – 1 Tim. 3:8-13

The word of God is the source of truth, nothing/nobody else!- John 17:17; John 1:1

DOCTRINE

1. Salvation- Faith PLUS works

"Sometimes people make it sound like the Catholic understanding of how to get to heaven is really complex. It's not. While you can go into any of Christ's teachings in a lot of very rich detail, he made sure that this one can be understood even by a child. I can summarize it in two sentences. The two sentences are these: To come to God and be saved, you need to repent, have faith, and be baptized. If you commit mortal sin, you need to repent, have faith, and go to confession."- Catholic Answers

What Catholicism Believes:

- The Sacraments are all different ways of earning grace toward salvation
    - **Baptism**: the first sacrament of initiation, which cleanses the soul of original sin and welcomes the individual into the Church.
    - **Confirmation**: the second sacrament of initiation, which strengthens the individual's faith and commitment to the Church.
    - **Eucharist**: the sacrament of the Body and Blood of Christ, which nourishes the soul and unites the individual with the Church and with Christ.
    - **Penance**: the sacrament of reconciliation, which allows the individual to confess their sins and receive absolution from a priest.
    - **Anointing of the Sick**: the sacrament of healing, which provides spiritual and physical comfort to those who are ill or suffering.
    - **Holy Orders**: the sacrament through which men are ordained as deacons, priests, or bishops to serve the Church.
    - **Marriage**: the sacrament of union between a man and a woman, which reflects the union between Christ and the Church.
- You CANNOT be saved if you are not a part of the Catholic Church (since the Catholic church is the only one true church and they are the ones who administer the sacraments)
    - The Catholic Church still holds that the Church is necessary for salvation and that no one knowing this can reject it and be saved. Vatican II teaches: "Whosoever knowing that the Catholic Church was made necessary by God through Jesus Christ would refuse to enter her or to remain in her could not be saved" (Lumen Gentium, no. 14).- Catholic Answers
- **Scripture passages they use**- James 2:17-26; John 6:53 (Eucharist); John 3:5 (baptism)
- **What they say about passages like Ephesians 2:8-9**

What the Bible Says:

- Salvation is by grace through faith alone (John 3:16; Eph. 2:8-9; Rom. 3:20-30; 6:23; 10:9-10,13; Galatians 2:16; 3:10-12; 5:4; Titus 3:5; Philippians 3:9; 1 Cor. 6:11; John 20:31)
- Anyone can be saved, no matter what church or denomination they belong to (Romans 10:13; John 3:16)
- The Bible says absolutely NOTHING about confessing to a priest or doing acts of penance (1 Tim. 2:5)
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2. The Pope

- The first pope was Peter (Matt. 16:18)
- The pope is to remain celibate (Matthew 8:14)
- The pope and priests are called "Father" (Matt. 23:1-10)
- The pope is "infallible" when they speak from "the chair" (Psalm 138:2; John 17:17)
- The popes is the Vicar of Christ "Christ on this earth" (Luke 21:8)

3. Mary the Mother of Jesus

- SHE was immaculately conceived and ascended to heaven without dying
- She was perfect and sinless (Rom. 3:23; 1 Jn. 1:8-10; Luke 1:46-47)
- She is the "queen of heaven" (Jeremiah 7:18; 44:17-25)
    - This is a false goddess that Israel was worshipping and it made God angry

4. The Ten Commandments

- "The Ten Commandments guide Catholics on how to live a righteous life and form the basis for Catholic moral teaching. Here is a list of the Ten Commandments as presented by the Catholic Church:" (Exodus 20:2-17)
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    - Thou shalt not steal.
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        - They are missing the commandment about idolatry and making idols out of images!

5. Purgatory

- "The Church gives the name Purgatory to this final purification of the elect, which is entirely different from the punishment of the damned. The Church formulated her doctrine of faith on Purgatory especially at the Councils of Florence and Trent"- Pope John XIX 1031 AD
- The "scripture" they use comes from the apocryphal book of 2 Maccabees
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- **What they say about passages like Ephesians 2:8-9-** "One passage Fundamentalists often cite as a proof against the Catholic view of salvation is Ephesians 2:8-9: "For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith—and this not from yourselves, it is the gift of God—not by works, so that no one can boast." Though this passage can often stymie Catholics in conversation, it is nothing to be threatened by. Even if we assume that Paul is speaking of "good works" when he says we have not been saved by works, this in no way conflicts with Catholic theology. Notice that the passage speaks of salvation in the past tense—"you have been saved." In Greek this is the perfect tense, which denotes a past, completed action."

What the Bible Says:

- Salvation is by grace through faith alone (John 3:16; Eph. 2:8-9; Rom. 3:20-30; 6:23; 10:9-10,13; Galatians 2:16; 3:10-12; 5:4; Titus 3:5; Philippians 3:9; 1 Cor. 6:11; John 20:31)
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3. Mary the Mother of Jesus

- SHE was immaculately conceived and ascended to heaven without dying
    - In the Gospel of Luke an angel visits a young woman in Nazareth named Mary and asks if she will bear the Messiah. Mary says yes. Then, presto! Mary becomes pregnant with Jesus. This is known as the immaculate conception, right? Wrong. Even though many Catholics connect this story in Luke's gospel with the term immaculate conception, the doctrine itself refers to something different. It still refers to Mary, but it is not about how Mary became pregnant with Jesus. It is about how Mary's mother became pregnant with her—deemed immaculate due to the absence of transmitting original sin. Pope Pius IX declared doctrine of the immaculate conception in his 1854 apostolic constitution Ineffabilis Deus (Ineffable God). Later, it was grandfathered into the First Vatican Council's declaration of papal infallibility in 1870. It is one of only two teachings to be declared ex cathedra, or infallibly, by a pope. The other is Mary's bodily assumption into heaven that was declared by Pope Pius XII in 1950.
- She was a lifelong virgin (Mark 6:3; Matt. 13:55; Gal. 1:19)
- She was perfect and sinless (Rom. 3:23; 1 Jn. 1:8-10; Luke 1:46-47)
- She is the "queen of heaven" (Jeremiah 7:18; 44:17-25)
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WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

WHY THIS STUDY?

Most people in our world today still believe in some sort of God. Though it can feel at times like the prevailing belief is Atheism (no God), the reality is that most people ascribe to some sort of religion. The reason for this study is to answer the age-old/tough question, "There are so many religions out there, how can we possibly know which one is right?" As we go through this study and examine the major religions of the world, we will come to a greater understanding of why we believe what we believe and we will be equipped to show people the truth about what the Bible says and what the truth is.

_____

FOUNDER

1. **Constantine (272-337 AD)**

   ✓ Provided the structure of the Catholic church

   ✓ Emperor of Rome from 306-337

   ✓ Fought victoriously against Maxentius over right for sole rulership

   ✓ 312 - Battle of Milvian Bridge the two meet.

   ✓ Constantine has a vision at some point during or before the battle.

   ✓ The vision consists of a cross in the shape of the first 2 letters of the Greek word for "Christ":



   ✓ He hears a voice saying "By this sign, thou shalt conquer" and proceeds to place this symbol on his soldier's helmets and shields. Because of his experience, Constantine now considers himself a "Christian".

   ✓ <u>Edict of Milan – 313</u>

   - A proclamation of "religious tolerance" in the entire Roman Empire with special benefits to "Christians".

   - Christians were granted absolute freedom and had property previously confiscated returned to them.

- Pagan temples offensive to Christianity were destroyed.
- Clergy were exempt from taxes and became paid by the state.
- By 324 Constantine promises 20 pieces of gold and a white robe for all new "converts".
- This begins the marriage of the church with the state.

✓ Council of Nicaea - 325

- Constantine invites all clergy to this "all expenses paid" meeting to determine the official doctrines of the Catholic Church. Delegates came from every region of the Roman Empire EXCEPT BRITAIN.
- The focus was on Christ and His relationship to God. They concluded with what is known as the Nicene Creed
- This would be revised in 381 with the additional doctrines adopted by the RCC.

Constantine married the pagan Roman system to "Christianity" in 313 AD with the Edict of Milan. Satan's counterfeit church was born. See Acts 19:35-37 for God's commentary on what would eventually take place. Also, remember that this system was not really new because of a man named Nimrod and the Tower of Babel. (Genesis 10:8-10)

✓ It is important to note that the Catholic church would say they began in Matthew 16:13-20

- The problem with this:
  - The word "Catholic" is not used until a few hundred years later
  - Jesus is the "Rock" all throughout the Bible, not Peter (Exo. 17:6; 1 Cor. 10:4; Luke 6:46-49)
  - The word he uses for Peter in vs. 18 is "petros" (little rock, stone) and the one he uses for "upon this **rock,** I will build my church" is "Petra" (large rock, boulder). Two different words for two different people.

✓ **Does the Bible talk about the RCC? (Revelation 17:1-9, 15, 18)**

- *What city/church has an affinity for drinking blood, has control over kings of the earth, has birthed the most false teachings/religions in the world, is "universal" (many waters), is known for killing the most Christians, their leaders where purple and scarlet, whose symbol is the golden cup (last supper), that is known as a "mother", and that sits on 7 hills?*



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✓ **Does the Bible talk about the RCC? (Revelation 17:1-9, 15, 18)**

✓ *Whoever this "woman" is…*

- *She is also known as "that great city, which reigneth over the kings of the earth" (Rev 17:18) We call it Vatican City today, and history reveals that city is the only city on earth who has ever reigned over kings of many nations. Ask Charlemagne about it! She is a political power who even has a seat in the United Nations! This "city" has a seat at the UN, and its leader is also its religious leader (pope) just like the bible describes the kingdom of the anti-christ*
- *She is the "mother of harlots and abominations of the earth" (meaning she birthed or many religions came from her) (Proverbs 7 shows the strange woman as a false religion)*
  - *Major religions that came from RCC (Presbyterians, Church of Christ, Episcopalians, Anglicans, Church of Nazarenes, Methodists, United Church of Christ, Congregationalists, 7th Day Adventists, Pentecostals, Lutherans, Assemblies of God, Church of God, Pietists, Eastern Orthodox, Restorationists, Disciples of Christ, Holiness Churches, etc…)*
  - *They would say that baptists came from them as well, however we have a different history completely, a history from those who fought and were martyred by Catholics throughout history (refer to the "trail of blood" booklet)*
- *She is "drunken with the blood of the saints, and with the blood of the martyrs of Jesus" (Rev 17:6) Through the centuries, the Roman Catholic Church has persecuted, tortured and murdered more Bible-believing Christians than pagan Rome ever thought to! Some historians estimate that the Roman Catholic Church is guilty of producing well over 50 million martyrs! (Some estimates go as high as 150 million!)*
- *The colors of the woman are "purple and scarlet" (the colors of clerical non-liturgical dress) and her symbol is a "golden cup" (a major feature in mass) according to Revelation 17:4.*

- *And if that weren't enough, Revelation 17:9 says that the woman sits on seven mountains. Rome has historically been known as the city on seven hills. Just type that into Google and see what the first result is!*

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WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

THE CHARISMATIC MOVEMENT (*Pentecostalism*)

DOCTRINE

***The great error of the Charismatic movement is that they think they are of the "apostle" lineage and can do the miracles and works of the apostles with the same authority. NONE of them have the power or display the miracles that the apostles did! (2 Corinthians 11:12-15; Rev. 2:2; Eph. 2:20)

- Jesus came to seek and to save Israel. Israel was told to look for someone who does signs like Moses (Deut. 18:15-18) who would do signs to prove he was from God (like Moses did in Egypt; Exo. 4:8; Deut. 34:11; 1 Cor. 1:22)
- Jesus gave that power and authority to the apostles, so they could do the signs for Israel to believe
- As God moved on to the rest of the world and as the Bible was being completed, signs were not needed anymore because God said there was a more perfect way coming, a **more sure** word of prophesy (1 Cor. 13:10; 2 Peter 1:19)

TONGUES

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- Speaking in tongues means that one speaks in an unintelligible/unknown language by the aid of the Holy Ghost, and this language is also referred to as a "heavenly language" spoken by angels (1Cor. 13:1).
- Speaking in tongues is the outward evidence of salvation and/or the outward evidence of a second outpouring of the Spirit on an individual (Acts 1:5; 2:1-21; 10:44-48; 19:4-7; Lk. 24:49; Mk. 16:15-20).
- The gift of tongues can be exercised in private and/or in public church services, and should not be forbidden (1 Cor. 14; Rom. 8:26)

What the Bible Says:

- Speaking in "tongues" is the ability to supernaturally and fluidly speak in a **known** language previously unknown to the speaker (Acts 2:1-21)
- Tongues is a sign gift for **unbelieving** Jews (Ex. 4; 1 Cor. 1:22; 14:22; Mk. 16:20; Acts 2:1-13; 10; 18:24-19:7)
- Tongues (and other sign gifts) progressively ceased with the completion of the New Testament scriptures and Church-Age transition (1 Cor. 13:8-13)
- When you are saved, the Holy Ghost lives and dwells in you permanently, it does not come and go (1 Cor. 6:18-20; 3:16; Eph. 1:14; 4:30)

HEALING

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- All sicknesses and physical ailments can be divinely healed by God through the prayer of **faith** (Mk. 16:17-18)
- The gift of healing can be a gift that a person possesses, but it can also be a gift that one may possess spontaneously at the discretion of the Holy Ghost (Acts 3:6-8; 5:15-16; 8:7; 9:34; 19:11-12; 28:8-9).
- **Faith** is key element for divine healing to work (Matt. 9:22, 28-29; Mk. 1:40-41; Acts 14:9-10; Jas. 5:15; Heb. 10:35-36; 1 Jn. 5:4-5).

What the Bible Says:

- Healing is a sign gift (Mk. 16:17-18; Ex. 4).
- Healing (and other sign gifts) progressively ceased with the completion of the New Testament scriptures and Church-Age transition (1 Cor. 13:8-13; 2 Tim. 4:20; Philippians 2:25-27)
- God is still heals people, but at His discretion and for His purposes (Rev. 1:9; current examples)

PROPHESYING

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- Anyone who is saved can at any moment become "spirit filled" and prophesy concerning any subject. Because it is from the spirit of God, it is taken as absolutely true and valid (Joel 2:28; 1 Cor. 14:1,5)

What the Bible says:

- Prophesying is simply God's people sharing God's already spoken words about future events (Ezekiel 13:1-3; 22:25,28; Jeremiah 14:13-14)

- What made any of the major or minor prophets prophets was the fact that they heard the word of God and shared it; we have the entire perfect word of God now already (Psalm 12:6-7)

- When the word of God is finished, prophesying will be done away with; it is not needed anymore (1 Cor. 13:9-10)

BAPTISMAL REGENERATION

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- You must be baptized to be saved (1 Peter 3:18-22; Acts 2:38)
- When you are baptized, you will be filled with the Holy Ghost and speak in tongues (Acts 2:1-5)

What the Bible says:

- Baptism is NOT required for salvation (Acts 8:37; Romans 6:23; 10:9-10,13; John 3:16; Eph. 2:8-9; Gal. 2:16; 3:10-12; 5:4; Titus 3:5; 1 Cor. 6:11; John 20:31)
- Speaking in tongues was a sign for unbelieving Jews, at a time the Bible was not completed (the NT had just begun), for them to trust in Christ, as the disciples were baptized with the Holy Ghost (not water) in the transitional book of Acts

LOSING SALVATION

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- Salvation is earned through works (baptism) and so it can be lost by works (or the lack thereof) (Matt. 7:21-23; 10:22)

What the Bible says:

- Salvation is a gift freely given, not earned by any works we do, it is solely by God that we are saved, therefore we cannot lose it, it is begun and finished by God (John 3:16; Romans 5:21; 6:23; Titus 3:7; 2 Corinthians 1:22; Eph. 1:13; 4:30; Romans 8:38-39)

KEY SUBJECTS CONCERNING THE CHARISMATIC MOVEMENT

A LOOK AT 1 CORINTHIANS 14 (1 Corinthians 14)

- Tongues vs Unknown Tongues

    - This church has people speaking in _____ tongues, out of order in services (people yelling out), women usurping authority in services, and absolute craziness happening in the church (1 Cor. 14:26-40)

    - If it is an unknown tongue, you SHOULD NOT be using it. It edifies nobody but yourself and creates chaos!

IF MIRACLES DO OCCUR, CAN WE TRUST THEM?

- The Bible tells us that miracles like this were for the Jews, done by the apostles, and they have ceased!

- If miracles are occurring, can we trust them? (Rev. 13:13-14; 16:13-14; 19:20; Matt. 24:24; Mark 13:22; 2 Thess. 2:9; Exodus 7:11, 20-22; 8:5-7)



WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE?
WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

THE CHARISMATIC MOVEMENT (*Pentecostalism*)

FOUNDERS

1. **Charles F. Parham (1873-1929)** - "American Pentecostal pioneer and author. He formulated classical Pentecostal theology in Topeka, Kansas, in 1901 and thus deserves recognition as the founder of the Pentecostal movement" *(Dictionary of Pentecostal and Charismatic Movements; pg. 660)*. Converted to Christianity at the age of thirteen he believed God had called him to the ministry. He entered college at the age of seventeen. Shortly thereafter, he recovered from a severe attack of rheumatic fever (he had an experience that drove his theology). This left him with the firm belief in the doctrine of divine healing. He left college three years later to assume the pastorate of a Methodist church. It was through this contact that he ultimately became enamored with the theology of the Holiness Movement (from the RCC). He left the Methodist church in 1895 to assume an independent ministry. He later married and began the Bethel Bible School. It was at this school that he developed the theology concerning speaking in tongues as the evidence of baptism in the holy spirit *(he originally believed them to be known foreign languages that thousands of missionaries would speak in order to evangelize the world before the second coming of Christ)*. **Agnes N. Ozman** was the first person to speak in unknown tongues at Parham's Bethel Bible School in Topeka, Kansas. Her experience is credited with validating Parham's assertion that tongues speech evidenced spirit baptism. She later became an evangelist. While the immediate impact of Parham's theology was limited, it gained more momentum several years later in a revival meeting held outside of Houston, Texas. From there **William J. Seymour**, a black holiness preacher convinced of the truth of Parham's teachings, traveled to Los Angeles, California, to preach the new message. The ensuing revival at the **Azusa Street Mission** (1906-1909) represented an anomaly on the American religious scene. In 1906 Parham's prominence in the new movement (not yet known as Pentecostal) was coming to an end due to rumors of him being a homosexual. In the summer of 1907 he was arrested on the charge of Sodomy. All charges were later dropped but the damage to his reputation was already done. Because the Holiness movement taught a person could come to a point of sinless perfection and Parham was a leader, his work was over.

2. **William J. Seymour** - William is a Holiness preacher that founded the Azusa Street Mission in Los Angeles, California. It was there that the "gift" of spirit baptism emerged and spread abroad in a religious wildfire. The sign gifts of the Holy Spirit, understood by other denominations throughout history as having ceased in the first century, had now been miraculously ***restored***. Evangelistic tent meetings were used across the U.S. by Pentecostals to spread the word.

Summary: Although Pentecostals and Charismatics claim that believers throughout the centuries spoke in tongues, they originally claimed these were known foreign languages used by missionaries to preach the gospel to foreigners. After decades of speaking in unknown tongues, Pentecostal theology was restructured and retro-fitted to work with the obvious experiences of their followers. Now they claim believers throughout history spoke in unknown tongues (Proverbs 5:6). **It is important to realize that most all Pentecostals and Charismatics do not know facts about Church History or facts concerning their own history**…

While the Charismatic movement is not necessarily the name of a particular group of churches, it is a religion that is very popular especially in todays world. It has infiltrated all sorts of churches under many names. Apostolic churches, primitive churches, church of Christ churches, and MANY "non-denominational" churches all fall under the charismatic movement. It is popular due to the "experience" factor that many people go to church to enjoy, and they find it at charismatic churches

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Bible** (translations vary, though most use modern versions)

2. **The personal ecstatic experiences of each believer** - Without realizing it, those that believe in charismatic doctrines have elevated their experience over the clear teaching of God's words, thus making their experience equal to, or greater than, the bible. Once a person has an "experience", it is almost impossible to convince them that what they are doing is unbiblical.

3. **The gift of prophesy -** One with this gift is "anointed" to fore-tell and/or forth-tell a message from God through preaching, speaking, and/or writing. They basically believe this gift to be a benefit to the church as it faces the challenges of the new millennium. The main problem is how to verify whether a "prophetic message" is from God or not. A whole theological system had to be developed by wresting the scriptures and historical facts to make this gift valid for today, but it is clearly no longer needed because everything we need can be found in a completed copy of the scriptures.

   → **Important Consideration – If it is not in the Bible, I do not need it; if it is in the Bible, I already have it!** So what is the purpose? God has laid out very plainly in His Word the fact that we can get clear answers to any and all areas of our life – 2 Peter 1:3-4.

Summary: Although the Bible clearly tells us not to "Judge not according to the appearance, but judge righteous judgment" (John 7:24), most Pentecostal/Charismatic believers that have experienced these gifts will not receive any scriptural truth that comes against their false teachings. All experiences must be judged by the infallible standard that is GREATER than any experience - the bible

DOCTRINE

***The great error of the Charismatic movement is that they think they are of the "apostle" lineage and can do the miracles and works of the apostles with the same authority. NONE of them have the power or display the miracles that the apostles did! (2 Corinthians 11:12-15; Rev. 2:2; Eph. 2:20)

- Jesus came to seek and to save Israel. Israel was told to look for someone who does signs like Moses (Deut. 18:15-18) who would do signs to prove he was from God (like Moses did in Egypt; Exo. 4:8; Deut. 34:11; 1 Cor. 1:22)
- Jesus gave that power and authority to the apostles, so they could do the signs for Israel to believe
- As God moved on to the rest of the world and as the Bible was being completed, signs were not needed anymore because God said there was a more perfect way coming, a **more sure** word of prophesy (1 Cor. 13:10; 2 Peter 1:19)

TONGUES

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- Speaking in tongues means that one speaks in an unintelligible/unknown language by the aid of the Holy Ghost, and this language is also referred to as a "heavenly language" spoken by angels (1Cor. 13:1).
- Speaking in tongues is the outward evidence of salvation and/or the outward evidence of a second outpouring of the Spirit on an individual (Acts 1:5; 2:1-21; 10:44-48; 19:4-7; Lk. 24:49; Mk. 16:15-20).
- The gift of tongues can be exercised in private and/or in public church services, and should not be forbidden (1 Cor. 14; Rom. 8:26)

What the Bible Says:

- Speaking in "tongues" is the ability to supernaturally and fluidly speak in a known language previously unknown to the speaker (Acts 2:1-21)
- Tongues is a sign gift for unbelieving Jews (Ex. 4; 1 Cor. 1:22; 14:22; Mk. 16:20; Acts 2:1-13; 10; 18:24-19:7)
- Tongues (and other sign gifts) progressively ceased with the completion of the New Testament scriptures and Church-Age transition (1 Cor. 13:8-13)
- When you are saved, the Holy Ghost lives and dwells in you permanently, it does not come and go (1 Cor. 6:18-20; 3:16; Eph. 1:14; 4:30)

**VIDEO

HEALING

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

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KEY SUBJECTS CONCERNING THE CHARISMATIC MOVEMENT

A LOOK AT 1 CORINTHIANS 14 (slides) (1 Corinthians 14)

- Tongues vs Unknown Tongues (show slides of bible versions)
- This church has people speaking in **unknown** tongues, out of order in services (people yelling out), women usurping authority in services, and absolute craziness happening in the church (1 Cor. 14:26-40)
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WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

MORMONISM (LDS AND FLDS)

FOUNDERS

1. **Joseph Smith Jr. (1805-1844)**
2. **HISTORY OF THE FLDS (FUNDAMENTALIST LATTER-DAY SAINTS)**

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Book of Mormon**

   **What does the Bible say about this kind of prophesying/new doctrine? (Gal. 1:8; 2 Cor. 11:13-14; Rev. 22:18; Matt. 11:13; Luke 16:16)

   **The Book of Mormon is nothing more than a made up copy of the Bible intermixed with a deceitful man's own set of beliefs. Much of the book is stolen and twisted directly from the Bible.

2. **Doctrine & Covenants, present Mormon prophets' words and writings** *(a.k.a. - the authority of men)*
3. **"The Pearl of Great Price"** - A selection of choice materials touching many significant aspects of the faith and doctrine of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints. These items were produced by Joseph Smith Jr. and were published in the Church periodicals of his day.

DOCTRINE

1. **Deny salvation by grace alone, the authority of the Bible alone, and the deity of Christ**
   a. They believe we can be saved "after all we can do" (2 Nephi 25:23)
2. **Jesus is Satan's brother** - Jesus was a created spirit and "son of God" before being given a physical body, just like all humans. In the Mormon text "Book of Moses," Satan and Jesus contend for the privilege of taking a body of flesh in order to become the redeemer, with Jesus winning the contest
3. **Afterlife and Hell** - All spirits go to the spirit world, undergo preparation, then rejoin with bodies in the resurrection. The good spend the intervening time in spirit paradise, while the wicked go to an unpleasant spirit prison. After that, only the most obstinately wicked (like Satan) will be consigned to "Outer Darkness" for eternity. They believe that there are levels to heaven as well
4. **Baptismal Regeneration** - Mormon's believe in baptism by immersion for the remission of sins. This would be for adults only (unless a child is old enough to make his/her own choice). The laying on of hands follows baptism for the receiving of the Holy Ghost (Mosiah 18:8-10; John 3:5)
5. **Polygamy** – This practice began with Joseph Smith after he received a "revelation" from God that this needed to start taking place again. He went on to quickly marry over 40 women, many already married, and many much younger than him (lower twenties and a 14 year old). The church "stopped practicing" this technically in 1890 after receiving threat to their money, property, and power; however the true fundamentalists still practice this to this very day, just like their founder did and as their ancient texts tell them to
6. **Baptism for the Dead** - Deemed a "sacred" ceremony, it is a proxy baptism by a living relative for their dead non-Mormon relative. This is absolutely necessary for the dead non-Mormon if he is to have any chance at eternal life in the afterworld. However, no chance of godhood exists for them. They will live in eternity as a type of sub-god (1 Cor. 15:29)
7. **Celestial Wedding** - Deemed "sacred" this is a temple ceremony only. A Mormon can only participate if he/she is recommended by their local bishop. This ceremony marries the couple for all eternity thus assuring eternal life to the wife and giving the man assurance of procreation when he becomes a god himself (Doctrine and Covenants 131:1-4)

8. **Other Strange Doctrines**

    a. **Melchizedekian Priesthood-** Those deemed worthy for this special priesthood after the order of Christ are given gifts to bless, heal, speak, etc… with apostle like authority

    b. **God the Father-** They believe that he is a fleshly being, not spiritual (John 1:18; Col. 1:15; John 4:23-24; 1 Tim. 1:17) They also believe that he had sex with multiple goddesses of heaven (spiritual beings) to produce all the spirits who would later become people. Also they believe that he had sex with Mary (Jesus mother) to create Jesus

    c. **The atonement for sin-** They believe that the atonement for sin was made in the garden of Gethsemane and not so much so on the cross (Eph. 2:16; Col. 1:20; 2:14)

    d. **Charismatic doctrines-** They practice healing, prophesying, speaking in unknown tongues, and many other charismatic doctrines

    e. **Jesus came to America-** After he rose from the dead, they believe Jesus came to a group of Jews that had migrated to America and he spoke with and ministered to them there. They believe this group later became the Native Americans

    f. **Jesus had children-** They believe that Jesus had multiple children with Mary Magdelene and Joseph Smith came from this lineage

NOTE: Obviously a faith plus works system. This even adds to faith plus works, in a sense, by what they call the "sacred" ordinances. These are blatant occult rituals that not every Mormon will be able to participate in. Thus they have a class of "better" heaven bound Mormons and a class of regular Mormons

JEHOVAH'S WITNESSES

FOUNDERS

1. **Charles Taze Russell (1852-1916)**
2. **Joseph F. Rutherford**

AUTHORITIES

1. **The "bible"**
    - *The New World Translation* – published 1961
    - Translation committee remained anonymous
    - Translated from same corrupt sources as all other modern translations
2. **The JW's Governing Body / World HQ in Brooklyn, New York**
    - Responsible for formulating policy and doctrines, producing material for publications and conventions, and administering its worldwide branch office staff
    - Membership is unelected; existing members invite new members to join the body

DOCTRINE

1. **Salvation**

    …WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

    Salvation comes through Jesus Christ alone, not through membership with any group, religion, organization, etc… (John 14:6; Acts 4:12)

    Salvation is **NOT** by any work that man can do - Eph 2:8-9; Matt 7:21-23; Titus 3:5

    You must believe that Jesus is the Son of God whose death on the cross paid the price for YOUR sin and receive that gift! - Rom 10:9-10; John 3:16; 1 John 1:9, 2:1-2

2. **Deny the triune nature of God** - JW's declare that God is one and that any doctrine that presents God as a 3-in-1 being is blasphemous (Deut. 6:4; Gal. 3:20; 1 Jn. 5:7; Gen. 1:26; John 1:1-2,14)

3. **Deny the deity of Jesus Christ** - JW's believe that Jesus is a created being with no divinity, the same as you and me (Matt. 19:17; John 1:1 (NWT); they also believe that Jesus is Michael the archangel

   **They say that Michael the archangel was in Heaven and when he needed to come to earth to save mankind, he became Jesus Christ

   The Bible teaches clearly that Michael the archangel and Jesus are not the same person

   -Jesus rebukes the devil, Michael does not- Matt. 4:10; Jude 9

   -Michael is an angel, Jesus is clearly shown as being distinctly better than and above angels- Hebrews chapters 1 & 2

   The Bible as a whole clearly teaches Jesus is fully God (slides)

   Jesus himself claims to be God - John 8:12-59, 10:22-33; Heb 1:8; Rev 1:8

   Titles reserved only for Jehovah are applied to Jesus:

   - *Creator* - Isaiah 44:24; John 1:1-3; Colossians 1:16
   - *Rock* - Deuteronomy 32:3-4, 12; 2 Samuel 22:1-2, 32…1 Corinthians 10:4
   - *Savior* - Isaiah 43:10-11…Titus 2:13; 2 Peter 1:1; Acts 20:28

4. **Other Strange Doctrines**

   - The earth will never be destroyed (Compare to: 2 Peter 3:7, 10-13; Isaiah 66:15,22; Rev 21:1-3)
   - No celebration of holidays or birthdays (Compare to: Ex 12:14-20; Col 2:16; Rom 14:5-8)
   - Baptism - This is performed in order for a person to become a member of the Society, and they are baptized in the name of the Father, the Son, and the organization (Compare to: Matt 28:19)
   - The Memorial of Christ's Death at Passover - This is the only ceremony that the JW's observe. At this ceremony, held in a large auditorium, all members are expected to be present. The elements of the Lord's Supper are passed through the audience, but only those of the anointed or heavenly class are allowed to partake (That number is now fewer than 9,000 worldwide since no one born after AD 1914 is considered eligible).
   - No blood transfusions (Gen. 9:4; Lev. 17:14)
   - Only 144,000 elect (Rev. 7:4-8) will be able to enter heaven, the rest who believe will be allowed to a type of purgatory here on earth



WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

MORMONISM (LDS AND FLDS)

FOUNDERS

1. **Joseph Smith Jr. (1805-1844)** - Original founder of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints. He claimed to have encountered God the Father and Jesus Christ who commissioned him to restore the "true church" and the "lost priesthood" to the earth. He claims that an angel named Moroni showed him an ancient book, which he translated using magical stones. In 1830 this book, known as the Book of Mormon, was published. On April 6, 1830, he founded his new church and his followers became known as Mormons. He was a very controversial man who was known as a charlatan and huckster. Everywhere he went he stirred up trouble because of his anti-biblical lifestyle. He ran for president of the U.S., established a private army, built a well-planned city named "Nauvoo" located in Illinois, elaborated his own theological belief structure, introduced new religious practices, and married over forty-nine women, at least twelve of whom had husbands and one of whom was only 14 years old (he was 37). He was ultimately arrested for these, and other, unlawful practices. On June 27, 1844, a lynch mob attacked the Carthage jail where he was held, and he and his brother Hyrum were murdered. His death provided his church with a martyr and created the transformation of an American folk religion into an international faith.
    2. "*I have more to boast of than ever any man had. I am the only man that has ever been able to keep a whole church together since the days of Adam. A large majority of the whole have stood by me. Neither Paul, Peter, nor Jesus ever did it. I boast that no man ever did such a work as I. The followers of Jesus ran away from Him; but the Latter-day Saints never ran away from me yet*." - ***Joseph Smith***
        i. His reputation:
        ii. Known con man
        iii. Hired himself out as a master treasure Hunter without ever finding any treasure
        iv. Arrested multiple times for charges of banking fraud, assault, conspiracy to commit murder, assembling his own aggressive militia, etc…
        v. Never shared/was able to prove any of his visions, golden tablets, seer stones, etc…
        vi. Caught by his wife having sex with 14 year old maid in barn (this is when he explains to his wife God gave him the revelation of polygamy)
        vii. Threatened to exterminate every non Mormon in Missouri
        viii. Ordered the assassination of Missouri's governor
        ix. Ordered the burning down and looting of villages in Missouri
        x. Constantly has new visions that conflict with old visions and the Bible whenever is clearly best suited his interests
        xi. He was a confused man (lived in a time of religious "awakening" in America, also in an area known for folk magic/ treasure hunting, and all sorts of pagan practices), with deceitful/cunning skills, poor moral character, who saw an opportunity and took it. When it didn't make much progress at first, he continued in slowly until he garnered a following.
3. **Brigham Young (1801-1877)-** - The Second leader of the church (Utah Mormons) after the death of Joseph Smith. He was originally ordained into the ministry as an apostle by Joseph Smith himself. Young led the exodus from Illinois to the Great Salt Lake Basin (1846-1848) after the death of Smith. As the head leader and administrator of the saints, he instructed his followers in everything from doctrine, architecture, and agriculture, to fashion and family relations. He ultimately became the governor of the Utah Territory. He used the immense power he possessed to establish some 350 communities and numerous economic ventures. He was so influential that the college (BYU) was named for him and has a STRONG Mormon population

a. Commonly taught that anyone who married interracially would be condemned to there version of Hell
b. Taught that the only way for people who leave Mormonism to be redeemed is through there own blood being spilt (death)

4. **HISTORY OF THE FLDS (FUNDAMENTALIST LATTER-DAY SAINTS)**- In 1890, when the leaders of mainstream Mormonism abandoned the practice of polygamy in a deal with the federal government to gain statehood for Utah, one group of adherents refused to give in. The resulting splinter group, the Fundamentalist Church of Latter-day Saints (FLDS) has continued the practice to this day, residing for most of the 20th century in or around the twin towns of Hildale and Colorado City on the Utah-Arizona border. It is important to note that these are the group that truly follows fundamental Mormon beliefs as stated by Joseph Smith and the original writings/prophesies. The modern day "Mormon (LDS)" group branched off of true theology of Mormons in order to keep peace with the government, keep statehood, power, money, and their organization.

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Book of Mormon** - The Book of Mormon has been proven to be scientifically, anthropologically, archeologically and historically inaccurate Even beyond inaccurate, it is a total and blatant fairy tale. It is a proven fact that the book is theologically contradicting to itself. These seem like harsh words to use, however, basic investigation proves this book to be nothing more than fiction. Read the following excerpt from the book "Joseph Smith and Money Digging" as to how Joseph Smith received some revelation concerning the Book of Mormon:
"Smith put a magical 'seer' stone into a hat, and then buried his face in the hat to exclude the light. Next, words in 'reformed Egyptian' (*no such language exists*) magically appeared with their translation, and Smith spoke the translation to a scribe who wrote it down. One of Smith's many wives, Emma Smith, confesses: 'In writing for your father, I frequently wrote day after day…He sitting with his face buried in his hat, with a stone in it, and dictating hour after hour.'"

   In addition, Smith claims that an angel named Moroni gave him the location of gold plates containing ancient writings in which he later translated the Book of Mormon. The gold plates were never seen by anyone nor do they exist today. Smith claimed the angel revisited him and took the plates back to God the Father. If he indeed did receive these plates and the visions, he did not get them from God (1 John 4:1-3)

   **What does the Bible say about this kind of prophesying/new doctrine? (Gal. 1:8; 2 Cor. 11:13-14; Rev. 22:18; Matt. 11:13; Luke 16:16)

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DOCTRINE

1. **Deny salvation by grace alone, the authority of the Bible alone, and the deity of Christ (**1 John 4:1-3)
   a. They believe Jesus was a created "sub-god" and not actually God in human flesh. He was the spirit son of the "heavenly father and heavenly mother" (they believe in both and that the heavenly mother is Mary). They do not believe he always was but believe he will continue to exist from here on forever.
   b. They believe we can be saved "after all we can do" (2 Nephi 25:23)
2. **Jesus is Satan's brother** - Jesus was a created spirit and "son of God" before being given a physical body, just like all humans. In the Mormon text "Book of Moses," Satan and Jesus contend for the privilege of taking a body of flesh in order to become the redeemer, with Jesus winning the contest

3. **Afterlife and Hell** - All spirits go to the spirit world, undergo preparation, then rejoin with bodies in the resurrection. The good spend the intervening time in spirit paradise, while the wicked go to an unpleasant spirit prison. After that, only the most obstinately wicked (like Satan) will be consigned to "Outer Darkness" for eternity. They believe that there are levels to heaven as well
4. **Baptismal Regeneration** - Mormon's believe in baptism by immersion for the remission of sins. This would be for adults only (unless a child is old enough to make his/her own choice). The laying on of hands follows baptism for the receiving of the Holy Ghost (Mosiah 18:8-10; John 3:5)
5. **Polygamy** – This practice began with Joseph Smith after he received a "revelation" from God that this needed to start taking place again. He went on to quickly marry over 40 women, many already married, and many much younger than him (lower twenties and a 14 year old). The church "stopped practicing" this technically in 1890 after receiving threat to their money, property, and power; however the true fundamentalists still practice this to this very day, just like their founder did and as their ancient texts tell them to
6. **Baptism for the Dead** - Deemed a "sacred" ceremony, it is a proxy baptism by a living relative for their dead non-Mormon relative. This is absolutely necessary for the dead non-Mormon if he is to have any chance at eternal life in the afterworld. However, no chance of godhood exists for them. They will live in eternity as a type of sub-god (1 Cor. 15:29)
7. **Celestial Wedding** - Deemed "sacred" this is a temple ceremony only. A Mormon can only participate if he/she is recommended by their local bishop. This ceremony marries the couple for all eternity thus assuring eternal life to the wife and giving the man assurance of procreation when he becomes a god himself (Doctrine and Covenants 131:1-4)
8. **Other Strange Doctrines**
    a. **Melchizedekian Priesthood-** Those deemed worthy for this special priesthood after the order of Christ are given gifts to bless, heal, speak, etc… with apostle like authority
    b. **God the Father-** They believe that he is a fleshly being, not spiritual (John 1:18; Col. 1:15; John 4:23-24; 1 Tim. 1:17) They also believe that he had sex with multiple goddesses of heaven (spiritual beings) to produce all the spirits who would later become people. Also they believe that he had sex with Mary (Jesus mother) to create Jesus
    c. **The atonement for sin-** They believe that the atonement for sin was made in the garden of Gethsemane and not so much so on the cross (Eph. 2:16; Col. 1:20; 2:14)
    d. **Charismatic doctrines-** They practice healing, prophesying, speaking in unknown tongues, and many other charismatic doctrines
    e. **Jesus came to America-** After he rose from the dead, they believe Jesus came to a group of Jews that had migrated to America and he spoke with and ministered to them there. They believe this group later became the Native Americans
    f. **Jesus had children-** They believe that Jesus had multiple children with Mary Magdelene and Joseph Smith came from this lineage

NOTE: Obviously a faith plus works system. This even adds to faith plus works, in a sense, by what they call the "sacred" ordinances. These are blatant occult rituals that not every Mormon will be able to participate in. Thus they have a class of "better" heaven bound Mormons and a class of regular Mormons

JEHOVAH'S WITNESSES

The Jehovah's Witnesses (JW) intensely train (disciple) their people concerning their false doctrines. Though today they do not experience substantial growth, those who do become members of the organization are well indoctrinated. They say they are learned in the scriptures, but are only familiar with the scriptures that seemingly support their wrested doctrines. They practice their witnessing techniques amongst themselves to better confound you. They can be very intimidating, but always remember that they do not know the Bible.

FOUNDERS

1. **Charles Taze Russell (1852-1916)** - Original founder of the Watchtower Bible and Tract Society. He was born February 16, 1852, near Pittsburgh. In 1870, while still in his teens and without any theological training, Russell organized a Bible class whose members eventually made him their "Pastor". The group also became known as "Russellites". He eventually married Maria Ackley, a woman who attended the Bible studies. In 1879 he founded the magazine *Zion's Watchtower* in which he published his own unique interpretation of the Bible, and in 1886, the first volume of seven books entitled *The Millennial Dawn* was published (later retitled Studies in the Scriptures). Russell's secret agenda was to make money. He developed multiple schemes for earning his filthy lucre from his followers and was taken to court on several occasions. His wife ultimately divorced him due to his lack of moral character and conman like persona.
    - → Russell's family background was Seventh Day Adventist… This is where the foundation of his false theology really began. Seventh Day Adventism has taken Bible truth that applies to Israel and adopted it for themselves. This is a grave theological error that shows up within the theology of the Jehovah's Witnesses. God gives His commentary on those people and organizations that do this deed (Rev. 2:9, 3:9). Russell did not like the idea of Hell and the founder of 7th day Adventism William Miller, taught that there was no hell. Russell followed Miller for years until the infamous "Great Disappointment" prophesy of Millers concerning the second coming of Christ occurring in 1874. When the prophesy failed Russell started to develop more of his own theology and garner more of a following of his own.
        - o Tried to predict the end of the world multiple times (1874, 1975, 1925, 1814, 1914) all were of course wrong
        - o He was also charged with profiteering for selling "miracle wheat" which was supposed to grow faster and be more healthy (it of course was not and did not)
        - o His wife divorced him for his immoral character and conman like persona
2. **Joseph F. Rutherford -** A few months after the death of Russell (1916), the society's legal counselor, Joseph Franklin "Judge" Rutherford, became the second president of the *Watchtower Society*. It was under his leadership that the name "Jehovah's Witnesses" was adopted. Rutherford moved the society's headquarters to Brooklyn, New York. He also moved toward theocratic control with the sole power to make all policy decisions. Rutherford saw the dangers of remaining "Russellites" and over a period of fifteen years labored to cover up the "Pastor's" unpleasant past.

AUTHORITIES

1. **The "bible"**
    - *The New World Translation* – published 1961
    - Translation committee remained anonymous
    - Translated from same corrupt sources as all other modern translations
2. **The JW's Governing Body / World HQ in Brooklyn, New York**
    - Responsible for formulating policy and doctrines, producing material for publications and conventions, and administering its worldwide branch office staff
    - Membership is unelected; existing members invite new members to join the body

The society is set up almost exactly like the RCC but without the formality. The leaders speak for God and what they say is equal (actually more so) with scripture. Without the JW leadership a person cannot understand what the Bible says. Men becoming the standard instead of God's Word is always a mark of a false teacher propagating false doctrine, and this is why God hates it (Rev. 2:6, 15).

DOCTRINE

1. **Salvation** - Salvation is only by joining the JW organization because it's the only way a person can learn Jehovah's will. If a person will faithfully carry out Jehovah's will in obedience to the instructions of the organization for the rest of their life, the reward is everlasting life on earth, and this is because there is almost NO chance of being with Jesus in heaven for all eternity. This special privilege is reserved for and already filled by a special class

(known as the anointed or heavenly class) of JW's limited to 144,000. If a person does good enough to pass the test, Jehovah will resurrect them on earth for another test of goods works and obedience which lasts 1,000 years. IF a person makes it through that successfully, and IF at the end Jehovah deems them worthy, then they will live on a renewed earth in a perfect human condition… and this will last as long as they do not rebel against Jehovah throughout eternity future

…WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

Salvation comes through Jesus Christ alone, not through membership with any group, religion, organization, etc… (John 14:6; Acts 4:12)

Salvation is **NOT** by any work that man can do - Eph 2:8-9; Matt 7:21-23; Titus 3:5

You must believe that Jesus is the Son of God whose death on the cross paid the price for YOUR sin and receive that gift! - Rom 10:9-10; John 3:16; 1 John 1:9, 2:1-2

2. **Deny the triune nature of God** - JW's declare that God is one and that any doctrine that presents God as a 3-in-1 being is blasphemous (Deut. 6:4; Gal. 3:20; 1 Jn. 5:7; Gen. 1:26; John 1:1-2,14)

3. **Deny the deity of Jesus Christ** - JW's believe that Jesus is a created being with no divinity, the same as you and me (Matt. 19:17; John 1:1 (NWT); they also believe that Jesus is Michael the archangel

**They say that Michael the archangel was in Heaven and when he needed to come to earth to save mankind, he became Jesus Christ

The Bible teaches clearly that Michael the archangel and Jesus are not the same person

-Jesus rebukes the devil, Michael does not- Matt. 4:10; Jude 9

-Michael is an angel, Jesus is clearly shown as being distinctly better than and above angels- Hebrews chapters 1 & 2

The Bible as a whole clearly teaches Jesus is fully God (slides)

Jesus himself claims to be God - John 8:12-59, 10:22-33; Heb 1:8; Rev 1:8

Titles reserved only for Jehovah are applied to Jesus:

- *Creator* - Isaiah 44:24; John 1:1-3; Colossians 1:16
- *Rock* - Deuteronomy 32:3-4, 12; 2 Samuel 22:1-2, 32…1 Corinthians 10:4
- *Savior* - Isaiah 43:10-11…Titus 2:13; 2 Peter 1:1; Acts 20:28

4. **Other Strange Doctrines**

- The earth will never be destroyed (Compare to: 2 Peter 3:7, 10-13; Isaiah 66:15,22; Rev 21:1-3)
- No celebration of holidays or birthdays (Compare to: Ex 12:14-20; Col 2:16; Rom 14:5-8)
- Baptism - This is performed in order for a person to become a member of the Society, and they are baptized in the name of the Father, the Son, and the organization (Compare to: Matt 28:19)
- The Memorial of Christ's Death at Passover - This is the only ceremony that the JW's observe. At this ceremony, held in a large auditorium, all members are expected to be present. The elements of the Lord's Supper are passed through the audience, but only those of the anointed or heavenly class are allowed to partake (That number is now fewer than 9,000 worldwide since no one born after AD 1914 is considered eligible).
- No blood transfusions (Gen. 9:4; Lev. 17:14)
- Only 144,000 elect (Rev. 7:4-8) will be able to enter heaven, the rest who believe will be allowed to a type of purgatory here on earth



WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

MENNONITE

FOUNDER- Menno Simons (1530)

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Bible**
2. **Tradition-** While they would claim that the Bible is their only authority, they have traditions within the church that usurp the biblical authority that does not force such traditions (peace/pacifism, washing of feet, clothing/dress (some not all))

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. **Scripture** - "Mennonites believe that all Scripture is inspired by God through the Holy Spirit for instruction in salvation and training in righteousness. We accept the Scriptures as the Word of God and as the fully reliable and trustworthy standard for Christian faith and life…"
2. **Salvation through Jesus Christ**- They believe in salvation by grace through faith alone
3. **Biblical Ordinances** – They believe in the two biblical ordinances of baptism and communion, however they do not baptize biblically in that they allow for sprinkling, pouring, and complete immersion. They do not teach complete immersion as the biblical way to baptize (Acts 8:38; Matt. 3:16)
4. **Eternal Security-** They do not believe in the eternal security of the believer. Because of their emphasis on holy living, law keeping, traditional living, they believe that you can become "apostate" and lose your salvation (1 Peter 1:15; 1 John 3:8-9; John 3:16; 2 Cor. 1:22; Eph. 1:13; 4:30; Romans 8:35-39)
5. **Emphasis of Peace/Pacifism-** They do not believe in preparing for war, participating in war or military service or any sort of actions that would go against their pacifist position (Ecc. 3:1-3; 1 Sam. 15:18; Jer. 50; 21)

AMISH

FOUNDER- Jakob Ammann (1693)

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Bible**
2. **Tradition-** While they would claim that the Bible is their only authority, they have traditions within the church that usurp the biblical authority that does not force such traditions (peace/pacifism, washing of feet, clothing/dress, no technology, lifestyle of 17th and 18th century Europe, shunning and excommunication of members, living separated from the rest of the world in the literal sense, etc…)

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. **Scripture** – "The Amish see the Bible as the inspired, inerrant Word of God." (many even use KJV)

2. **Salvation through Jesus Christ**- They believe in salvation by grace through faith alone

3. **Biblical Ordinances** – They believe in the two biblical ordinances of baptism and communion, however they do not baptize biblically in that they allow for sprinkling, pouring, and complete immersion. They do not teach complete immersion as the biblical way to baptize (Acts 8:38; Matt. 3:16)

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6. **Separation**- Isolating themselves from the rest of society is one of the key Amish beliefs. They think secular culture has a polluting effect that promotes pride, greed, immorality and materialism. Therefore, to avoid the use of television, radios, computers, and modern appliances, they do not hook up to the electrical grid (Rom. 12:2; 2 Cor. 6:17; John 17:13-21)

7. **Evangelism**- Originally, the Amish evangelized, as do most Christian denominations, but over the years seeking converts and spreading the gospel became less and less of a priority, to the point that it is not done at all today (Matt. 28:19-20; Mark 16:15; Rom. 1:16; 2 Tim. 4:5)

8. **Shunning**- One of the controversial Amish beliefs, shunning, is the practice of social and business avoidance of members who violate the rules. Shunning is rare in most Amish communities and is only done as a last resort. Those who are excommunicated are always welcomed back if they repent (1 Cor. 5:1-5; 1 Tim. 1:20; Gal. 6:1-2; 2 Thess. 3:14-15)



WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

MENNONITE

FOUNDER- Menno Simons (1530)
Menno Simons (1496 – 31 January 1561) He was a Roman Catholic priest from the Friesland region of the Low Countries who was excommunicated from the Catholic Church and became an influential Anabaptist religious leader. Simons was a contemporary of the Protestant Reformers and it is from his name that his followers became known as Mennonites. His time as a Roman Catholic Priest for 20 years of his life and his time as a young man in a war torn country both greatly influenced his theology over the years. Although he was considered as a branch off from Anabaptists, he was highly influenced by his Catholic doctrine, traditions of men, and distaste for war.

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Bible**
2. **Tradition-** While they would claim that the Bible is their only authority, they have traditions within the church that usurp the biblical authority that does not force such traditions (peace/pacifism, washing of feet, clothing/dress (some not all))

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. **Scripture** - "Mennonites believe that all Scripture is inspired by God through the Holy Spirit for instruction in salvation and training in righteousness. We accept the Scriptures as the Word of God and as the fully reliable and trustworthy standard for Christian faith and life…"

2. **Salvation through Jesus Christ**- They believe in salvation by grace through faith alone

    a. They do emphasize repentence as a part of salvation which can be taken multiple ways. They make your actions of repentance a large part/sign of salvation, so much so that they almost add works to salvation and as we will see, believe you can "lose" salvation

3. **Biblical Ordinances** – They believe in the two biblical ordinances of baptism and communion, however they do not baptize biblically in that they allow for sprinkling, pouring, and complete immersion. They do not teach complete immersion as the biblical way to baptize (Acts 8:38; Matt. 3:16)

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5. **Emphasis of Peace/Pacifism-** They do not believe in preparing for war, participating in war or military service or any sort of actions that would go against their pacifist position (Ecc. 3:1-3; 1 Sam. 15:18; Jer. 50; 21)

a. The issue with this is the idea that they are adding undue burdern/law to believers lives by adding to the bible laws that God has not enforced us to obey. Nowhere in the Bible are we ordered not to participate in wars or conflicts, especially when necessary. We ought to keep peace when possible, but if not possible we are absolutely allowed to war/fight

AMISH

FOUNDER- Jakob Ammann (1693) Jakob Ammann was a Mennonite pastor and, via a church schism, founder of the Amish branch of Anabaptism. Ammann sought reform in the form of more frequent communion services and the practice of regular social avoidance (shunning), which others practiced only symbolically. Amman's conflicts with other leaders which he perceived as spiritually lax proved unresolvable. He consistently called for harsher enforcement of rules, regulations, traditions of men, and undue burdens on fellow believers that are not found as such in the Bible. These issues ultimately caused him and his followers to split off from the Mennonites and form what came to be known as the Amish.

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Bible**
2. **Tradition-** While they would claim that the Bible is their only authority, they have traditions within the church that usurp the biblical authority that does not force such traditions (peace/pacifism, washing of feet, clothing/dress, no technology, lifestyle of 17th and 18th century Europe, shunning and excommunication of members, living separated from the rest of the world in the literal sense, etc…)

    a. Here are some weird amish traditions/beliefs

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. **Scripture** – "The Amish see the Bible as the inspired, inerrant Word of God." (many even use KJV)

2. **Salvation through Jesus Christ**- They believe in salvation by grace through faith alone

    a. Again, they emphasize repentence as a part of salvation which can be taken multiple ways. They make your actions of repentance a large part/sign of salvation, so much so that they almost add works to salvation and as we will see, believe you can "lose" salvation

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    a. If a miser does not turn from his fornication, and a drunkard from his drunkenness, or other immoralities, they are thereby separated from the kingdom of God, and if he

does not improve himself through a pious, penitent life, such a person is no Christian and will not inherit the Kingdom of God.

5. **Emphasis of Peace/Pacifism-** They do not believe in preparing for war, participating in war or military service or any sort of actions that would go against their pacifist position (Ecc. 3:1-3; 1 Sam. 15:18; Jer. 50; 21)

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WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

PROTESTANTISM

<u>3 Major Branches of Protestantism:</u>

1. Lutheran (Martin Luther- 1520)
2. Anglican/Church of England (King Henry VIII- 1521)
3. Reformed (John Calvin- 1530)

LUTHERAN

FOUNDERS

1. **Martin Luther (1483-1546)**

AUTHORITIES

- The Bible
- Creeds/Church Tradition

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. Grace Alone… Faith Alone… Scripture Alone… (Eph. 2:8-9; Rom. 1:16-17; 10:17)
2. Baptismal Regeneration (Acts 8:36-38; 10:47-48; Rom. 10:9-10, 13; 6:3-4; 1Pt. 3:21)
3. Confession and Absolution of Sins to Pastors (1 Tim. 2:5; Is. 64:6; 59:2; Phil. 3:9; Rom. 3:21-26)
4. Transubstantiation (John 6:41-71; Acts 15:20, 29; Gen. 9:4; Lev. 17:11)

PRESBYTERIAN

FOUNDERS

1. **John Calvin (1509-1564)**
2. **John Knox (1514-1572)**

AUTHORITIES

- The Bible
- Teachings of John Calvin/other commentators

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. Grace Alone… Faith Alone… Scripture Alone… (Eph. 2:8-9; Rom. 1:16-17; 10:17)

2. Salvation by Predestination - *Calvinism* (1Jn. 2:2; 2Pt. 3:9; Jn. 3:16; Romans 8:29)

3. Replacement Theology - *God is done with Israel* (Rom. 9-11; Heb. 8; Ezek. 36-37; Am. 9; Zech. 8, 12, 14; Is. 49, 54, 60; Rom. 11:1-2, 25-26)

4. Churches should be governed by an overseeing Presbytery (Acts 14:23; Tts. 1:5; 1Pt. 5:1-4; 1 Tim. 4:14)

****CALVINISM**- This is the description of overarching teachings of John Calvin that can be found in any church (of course Presbyterian but also non denominational and even many Baptist churches)

- Calvinism holds to teachings 1-3 listed above but does not teach/emphasize the extra office of the presbytery. They are more liberal generally speaking and don't have quite the Catholic feel (special clergy clothing, services, etc…) that Presbyterian churches have. Most "Calvinist" churches have "reformed" in their name and services/churches would look very similar to ours in most other ways.
- Out of the Presbyterian Denomination came the **Church of Christ** and the **Disciples of Christ**

ANGLICAN

FOUNDERS

1. **King Henry VIII (1521)**

AUTHORITIES

- The Bible
- Creeds/Church Tradition

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. The Holy Scriptures of the Old and New Testaments, as "containing all things necessary to salvation," and as being the rule and ultimate standard of faith (2Tim. 3:16-17; 2Pt. 1:19-21)

2. The Creeds (*specifically, the Apostles' and Nicene*) as the sufficient statement of Christian faith (Rev. 2:6; 1Pt. 1:23; Rom. 10:17)

3. Infant Baptist/Baptism for salvation (Eph. 2:8-9; Acts 8:36-38; John 3:16; Rom. 10:9-10,13)

4. The historic episcopate locally adapted - *a hierarchy of bishops that oversee congregations* (Acts 14:23; Tts. 1:5; Phill. 1:1)

WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

METHODIST

FOUNDER- John Wesley

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. **Scripture**
2. **Salvation through Jesus Christ**
3. **Sanctification**
4. **Eternal Security/Holiness-** While they emphasize personal holiness and sanctification, Methodists go too far with this and state that if you don't live "good enough" that you can lose your salvation (1 Peter 1:15; 1 John 3:8-9; John 3:16; 2 Cor. 1:22; Eph. 1:13; 4:30; Romans 8:35-39)
5. **Connectional Model of Church Government** - Pastors are appointed to congregations by bishops, and lay members have limited representative authority in the local business of the church and national Methodist councils and conferences (Acts 14:23; Tts. 1:5; 1Pt. 5:1-4)
6. **Women Pastors/Supports LGBTQ community**- This church ordains women to be pastors, supports the LGBTQ community, and even flies their flag at the Methodist headquarters in London (1 Tim. 3:1-2; Titus 1:6; Lev. 20:13; 18:22; Rom. 1:26-32)

Out of the Methodist denomination came the **United Methodist**, **Salvation Army**, **Pentecostal**, **Assembly of God**, **Foursquare Gospel**, and the **Church of the Nazarene** denominations.

SEVENTH DAY ADVENTISM

FOUNDERS

1. **William Miller (1782-1849)**
2. **Ellen Gould White (1827-1915)**

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Bible**
2. **The Writings of Ellen White (their prophetess)** - The church believes her writings to be "inspired commentary on the Bible, not of human origin, contain doctrinal authority, and are unquestionable." It is important to note that the SDA website only speaks of the Holy Bible as the final authority, but Adventists will use her writings to reinforce their unbiblical doctrines.

DOCTRINE

HELL IS NOT ETERNAL

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ Hell does not currently exist and that it is temporary.
- ✓ All unbelievers will be annihilated after they have suffered long enough (Mal. 4:1, 3)

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Hell does currently exist (Lk. 16:19-31; Jon. 2:1-2)
- ✓ Hell is eternal (Matt. 18:8; 25:41; Jde. 1:7)
- ✓ The dead are not consumed (Mk. 9:42-48; Rev. 14:11)

"SABBATH" KEEPING

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ Keeping the Sabbath is still required by God and that it is the seal of a true believer

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Keeping the Sabbath was a sign for the Jews (Eze. 20:12, 20)
- ✓ Jesus expressly "broke" the Sabbath (Ex. 16:22-26 cf. Matt. 12:1-8)
- ✓ The Sabbath was a day of rest (Ex. 31:12-17)
- ✓ Our rest is in Jesus and not in a day of the week (Matt. 11:28; Heb. 4:1-10; Col. 2:16; Gal. 4:10-11)
    - Every other commandment is found in the NT as something that believers ought to follow (9/10 commandments) except for this one. It is finished, it was for the Jews.

"Holiness" type living

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ They focus on keeping the OT law as Christians today. They apply much of the OT to us today and therefore cast undue burdens onto the lives of Christians that Christ came to bear for us. With this belief comes the teaching that salvation can be earned/lost if you do not keep the law to an "unknown standard"

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Once you are saved, you are ALWAYS SAVED (John 3:16; 2 Cor. 1:22; Eph. 1:13; 4:30; Romans 8:35-39)
- ✓ We ought to strive to live holy lives (sanctified/separated) but sin is a daily fight/battle that ALL Christians struggle with (Rom. 7:14-20)

SATAN BEARS OUR SINS

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ "It was seen, also, that while the sin offering pointed to Christ as a sacrifice, and the high priest represented Christ as a mediator, the scapegoat typified Satan, the author of sin, upon whom the sins of the truly penitent will finally be placed" *The Great Controversy*
- ✓ "Their sins are transferred to the originator of sin" *Testimonies for the Church*

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Jesus Christ bore our sins in his body (Is. 53:4-6; Jn. 1:29; 1 Pet. 2:24)
- ✓ To say that Satan takes the sin of mankind is to make him the savior! This is blasphemy!

OUR BAPTIST HERITAGE

AUTHORITY

1. **The Bible** - 1Cor. 2:16; Ps. 138:2; Jn. 1:1, 14; Rev. 19:13; Jn. 10:35; Prov. 30:5-6; Ps. 12:6-7; 119:89; Jn. 10:35; Matt. 5:18; Rev. 20:12

DOCTRINE

1. **The Bible, Rightly-Divided and Correctly Applied**
    - ✓ Our doctrine comes as we believe what the bible says (2Pt. 1:3, 16-21; 2Tim. 3:15-17; 1Cor. 2:11-16)
    - ✓ Salvation by grace, through faith in the finished work Christ ALONE (Jn. 3:16, 36; 1Jn. 2:2; 2Cor. 5:17-21)



WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE?
WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

PROTESTANTISM

3 Major Branches of Protestantism:

1. Lutheran (Martin Luther- 1520)
2. Anglican/Church of England (King Henry VIII- 1521)
3. Reformed (John Calvin- 1530)

LUTHERAN

FOUNDERS

1. **Martin Luther (1483-1546)**

AUTHORITIES

- The Bible
- Creeds/Church Tradition

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. Grace Alone… Faith Alone… Scripture Alone… (Eph. 2:8-9; Rom. 1:16-17; 10:17)
2. Baptismal Regeneration (Acts 8:36-38; 10:47-48; Rom. 10:9-10, 13; 6:3-4; 1Pt. 3:21)
3. Confession and Absolution of Sins to Pastors (1 Tim. 2:5; Is. 64:6; 59:2; Phil. 3:9; Rom. 3:21-26)
4. Transubstantiation (John 6:41-71; Acts 15:20, 29; Gen. 9:4; Lev. 17:11)

PRESBYTERIAN

FOUNDERS

1. **John Calvin (1509-1564)**
2. **John Knox (1514-1572)**

AUTHORITIES

- The Bible
- Teachings of John Calvin/other commentators

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. Grace Alone… Faith Alone… Scripture Alone… (Eph. 2:8-9; Rom. 1:16-17; 10:17)

2. Salvation by Predestination - *Calvinism* (1Jn. 2:2; 2Pt. 3:9; Jn. 3:16; Romans 8:29)

3. Replacement Theology - *God is done with Israel* (Rom. 9-11; Heb. 8; Ezek. 36-37; Am. 9; Zech. 8, 12, 14; Is. 49, 54, 60; Rom. 11:1-2, 25-26)

4. Churches should be governed by an overseeing Presbytery (Acts 14:23; Tts. 1:5; 1Pt. 5:1-4; 1 Tim. 4:14)

-This phrase shows up on 1x in your whole Bible, and they take it to be some new/different office of church leadership that is not biblical and is not biblically mandated. This simply is a word for the church leadership.

****CALVINISM**- This is the description of overarching teachings of John Calvin that can be found in any church (of course Presbyterian but also non denominational and even many Baptist churches)

- Calvinism holds to teachings 1-3 listed above but does not teach/emphasize the extra office of the presbytery. They are more liberal generally speaking and don't have quite the Catholic feel (special clergy clothing, services, etc…) that Presbyterian churches have. Most "Calvinist" churches have "reformed" in their name and services/churches would look very similar to ours in most other ways.
- Out of the Presbyterian Denomination came the **Church of Christ** and the **Disciples of Christ**

ANGLICAN

FOUNDERS

1. **King Henry VIII (1521)**

AUTHORITIES

- The Bible
- Creeds/Church Tradition

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. The Holy Scriptures of the Old and New Testaments, as "containing all things necessary to salvation," and as being the rule and ultimate standard of faith (2Tim. 3:16-17; 2Pt. 1:19-21)

2. The Creeds (*specifically, the Apostles' and Nicene*) as the sufficient statement of Christian faith (Rev. 2:6; 1Pt. 1:23; Rom. 10:17)

3. Infant Baptist/Baptism for salvation (Eph. 2:8-9; Acts 8:36-38; John 3:16; Rom. 10:9-10,13)

4. The historic episcopate locally adapted - *a hierarchy of bishops that oversee congregations* (Acts 14:23; Tts. 1:5; Phill. 1:1)



WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

METHODIST

FOUNDER- John Wesley

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. **Scripture** - The writings in the Old Testament and New Testament are the inspired word of God (2Tim. 3:16-17; 2Pt. 1:19-21)
2. **Salvation through Jesus Christ** - God's redeeming love is active to save sinners through Jesus' incarnate life and teachings, through his atoning death, his resurrection, his sovereign presence through history, and his promised return (Eph. 2:8-9; Rom. 1:16-17; 10:17)
3. **Sanctification** - The grace of sanctification draws one toward the gift of Christian perfection, which Wesley described as a heart "habitually filled with the love of God and neighbor" and as "having the mind of Christ and walking as he walked." (Rom. 8:29; 1Cor. 1:2, 30; 1Thess. 4:3)
4. **Eternal Security/Holiness-** While they emphasize personal holiness and sanctification, Methodists go too far with this and state that if you don't live "good enough" that you can lose your salvation (1 Peter 1:15; 1 John 3:8-9; John 3:16; 2 Cor. 1:22; Eph. 1:13; 4:30; Romans 8:35-39)
5. **Connectional Model of Church Government** - Pastors are appointed to congregations by bishops, and lay members have limited representative authority in the local business of the church and national Methodist councils and conferences (Acts 14:23; Tts. 1:5; 1Pt. 5:1-4)
6. **Women Pastors/Supports LGBTQ community**- This church ordains women to be pastors, supports the LGBTQ community, and even flies their flag at the Methodist headquarters in London (1 Tim. 3:1-2; Titus 1:6; Lev. 20:13; 18:22; Rom. 1:26-32)

Out of the Methodist denomination came the **United Methodist**, **Salvation Army**, **Pentecostal**, **Assembly of God**, **Foursquare Gospel**, and the **Church of the Nazarene** denominations.

SEVENTH DAY ADVENTISM

FOUNDERS

1. **William Miller (1782-1849)**
2. **Ellen Gould White (1827-1915)**

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Bible** (translations vary, some use KJV or multiple versions, Clear Word Bible is a SDA paraphrase though may not be in use today)
2. **The Writings of Ellen White (their prophetess)** - The church believes her writings to be "inspired commentary on the Bible, not of human origin, contain doctrinal authority, and are unquestionable." It is

important to note that the SDA website only speaks of the Holy Bible as the final authority, but Adventists will use her writings to reinforce their unbiblical doctrines.

DOCTRINE

HELL IS NOT ETERNAL

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ Hell does not currently exist and that it is temporary.
- ✓ All unbelievers will be annihilated after they have suffered long enough (Mal. 4:1, 3)

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Hell does currently exist (Lk. 16:19-31; Jon. 2:1-2)
- ✓ Hell is eternal (Matt. 18:8; 25:41; Jde. 1:7)
- ✓ The dead are not consumed (Mk. 9:42-48; Rev. 14:11)

"SABBATH" KEEPING

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ Keeping the Sabbath is still required by God and that it is the seal of a true believer. Those who do not keep the Sabbath will take the mark of the beast due to their ignorance of the scriptures. This is the main focus of the religion and look down upon those who do not observe a sundown Friday to sundown Saturday Sabbath (See any OT reference to "Sabbath")

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Keeping the Sabbath was a sign for the Jews (Eze. 20:12, 20)
- ✓ Jesus expressly "broke" the Sabbath (Ex. 16:22-26 cf. Matt. 12:1-8)
- ✓ The Sabbath was a day of rest (Ex. 31:12-17)
- ✓ Our rest is in Jesus and not in a day of the week (Matt. 11:28; Heb. 4:1-10; Col. 2:16; Gal. 4:10-11)
    - Every other commandment is found in the NT as something that believers ought to follow (9/10 commandments) except for this one. It is finished, it was for the Jews.

"Holiness" type living

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ They focus on keeping the OT law as Christians today. They apply much of the OT to us today and therefore cast undue burdens onto the lives of Christians that Christ came to bear for us. With this belief comes the teaching that salvation can be earned/lost if you do not keep the law to an "unknown standard"

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Once you are saved, you are ALWAYS SAVED (John 3:16; 2 Cor. 1:22; Eph. 1:13; 4:30; Romans 8:35-39)
- ✓ We ought to strive to live holy lives (sanctified/separated) but sin is a daily fight/battle that ALL Christians struggle with (Rom. 7:14-20)

SATAN BEARS OUR SINS

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ "It was seen, also, that while the sin offering pointed to Christ as a sacrifice, and the high priest represented Christ as a mediator, the scapegoat typified Satan, the author of sin, upon whom the sins of the truly penitent will finally be placed" *The Great Controversy*
- ✓ "Their sins are transferred to the originator of sin" *Testimonies for the Church*

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Jesus Christ bore our sins in his body (Is. 53:4-6; Jn. 1:29; 1 Pet. 2:24)
- ✓ To say that Satan takes the sin of mankind is to make him the savior! This is blasphemy!

OUR BAPTIST HERITAGE

HISTORY

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FUNDAMENTAL DOCTRINES OF A BIBLICAL, NEW TESTAMENT CHURCH *("Trail of Blood" by Dr. J. M. Carroll)**:***

1. *A spiritual Church, Christ its founder, its only head and law giver.* (Lk. 17:21; Rom. 14:17; 12:5; Acts 20:28; Eph. 5:23; 4:12; Col. 1:14, 18, 27)
2. *Its ordinances: Only two, Baptism and the Lord's Supper. They are typical and memorial, not saving.* (Matt. 28:19-20; Acts 10:47; 1Pt. 3:21; 1Cor. 12:13; 11:24-25)
3. *Its officers: Only two, bishops or pastors and deacons; they are servants of the church.* (1 Tim 3:1-2, 8-13; Titus 1:5-7; Acts 20:17, 28)
4. *Its Government: A pure Democracy, and that executive only, never legislative.* (Acts 6:1-7; 14:21-23; Tts. 1:5; 1Tim., 2Tim., Tts.)
5. *Its laws and doctrines: The New Testament and that only.* (Acts 10 - Philemon)
6. *Its members: Believers only, they saved by grace, not works, through the regenerating power of the Holy Spirit.* (Rom. 10:9-10, 13; 8:9; Eph. 1:13-14; 2:8-9; 2Cor. 5:17, 21; Tts. 3:4-6)
7. *Its requirements: Believers on entering the church to be baptized, that by immersion, then obedience and loyalty to all New Testament laws.* (Acts 8:35-38; 16:14-15, 29-34, 40)
8. *The various churches -- separate and independent in their execution of laws and discipline and in their responsibilities to God--but cooperative in work.* (Acts: Church in Jerusalem vs. Antioch vs. Corinth, etc.)
9. *Complete separation of Church and State.* (Lk. 20:20-26; Jn 18:36; Dan. 2:44; 7:14)
10. *Absolute Religious liberty for all.* (Eccl. 11:9-10; 12-13-14; Jn. 6:44; 12:32; 2Pt. 3:8; 1Jn. 2:2; 2Cor. 5:14-15)

Anabaptists → Baptists

1. Montanists (190AD - 500AD)
2. Donatists (300AD - 800AD)
3. Paulicans (700AD - 1200AD)

4. Arnoldists (1200AD - 1300AD)
5. Albigenses (1300AD - 1400AD)
6. Waldenses (1300AD - 1700AD)
7. Baptists(1550AD-TODAY)

- What she wears
- The drinking of blood
- The seven hills of Rome
- She is the mother of harlots (false religions)
- She is universal (many waters)
- She has killed many martyrs
- She has control over the kings of the Earth
- Her symbol is a golden cup
- She is known as “mother”

Name ways in which the woman described in Revelation chapter 17 lines up with the Roman Catholic Church